Wenqiu Tang

M.Sc. Candidate | LLM Representation Learning & Multimodal Agents

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Research Profile

M.Sc. candidate at Nagoya University researching inference-time intervention and mechanistic interpretability for large language models and multimodal agents. First author of papers at PAKDD 2026, INTERSPEECH 2026, and AACL 2026. I develop training-free methods to identify and steer internal representations, enabling fine-grained control of personality traits and emotional expression in generated speech, as well as more accurate reasoning about users' emotional states. My methods include sparse-autoencoder-based routing and causal localization of attention heads. My future research interests center on long-context multimodal reasoning in omni-models, particularly identifying and reasoning over task-relevant information amid substantial noise and redundancy in long, real-world videos.

Education

M.Sc. in Informatics — Nagoya University 2025–2027 (expected)
Department of Intelligent Systems, Graduate School of Informatics, Nagoya, Japan
Advisor: Prof. Ichiro Ide

Master's Studies in Sport and Olympic Studies — University of Tsukuba Apr. 2024–Apr. 2025
Graduate School of Comprehensive Human Sciences, Tsukuba, Japan
Focus: Developing Sports Tourism Agents

B.A. in Tourism Management — Huaqiao University 2019–2023
Quanzhou, China
GPA: 4.54/5.00 | Ranked 1st in the Department of Tourism Management

Research Experience

Research Assistant — Nagoya University 2025–present
WISE Program: Transdisciplinary Mobility Innovation (TMI)

- Investigate inference-time representation learning for frozen LLMs and multimodal agents; translate research hypotheses into reproducible interventions, controlled experiments, ablations, and multi-metric evaluations.

Master's Publications

Emotion Is Not External Knowledge: Internal Attention Signals for Affective State Reasoning
First author *[arXiv]* AACL 2026 · Main Conference

- Proposed training-free Self-targeted Internal Attention Boosting (SIAB) to causally localize and strengthen affective heads; improved prompt-matched baselines by up to +10.3 macro-F1 on ECC and GoEmotions.

Facet-Level Persona Control by Trait-Activated Routing with Contrastive SAE
First author / *DOI* / *arXiv* / *Code* PAKDD 2026

- Developed interpretable, facet-level persona control with contrastive sparse autoencoders and context-dependent routing; evaluated on a balanced, leakage-controlled 15,000-sample corpus.

DeSRPA: Decoupled Speech Role-Playing Agent via Inference-Time Intervention
First author / *Paper* / *Demo* / *Code* INTERSPEECH 2026

- Connected frozen Qwen3-4B and StyleTTS2 through separate cognitive and acoustic controls; evaluated controllable generation, speaker similarity, WER, latency, and human judgments.

Bachelor's Publications

Tourism Studies (in Chinese)

[1] Chunfa Chen, **Wenqiu Tang**, Lisi Yao, Yiran Wang. *A Study on the Deep Motivation of College Student Tourism Volunteers.* Tourism Overview, no. 11, pp. 18–21, 2022. [CNKI].

[2] **Wenqiu Tang**, Xinyu Li. *Research on the path of Fuding white tea culture to promote tea industry.* Tea in Fujian, no. 6,pp. 47–49 2022. [CNKI].

[3] **Wenqiu Tang**, Xiangli Fan, Lisi Yao. *Exploring the path to improve the effect of the elderly study tour experience.* China Adult Education, no. 24, pp. 33–37, 2021. [CNKI].

Technical Skills

Programming and ML: Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers; transformer architectures, sparse autoencoders, contrastive learning, representation engineering, activation steering.
Data and evaluation: Controlled dataset construction, data leakage prevention, automatic and human evaluation, multi-metric benchmarking, reproducible research pipelines.
Multimodal systems: Qwen3-4B, StyleTTS2, emotion2vec, WavLM, controllable speech generation, cross-model representation integration.

Honors and Languages

National Scholarship, Ministry of Education, China 2019–2020

First-Class Scholarship for Outstanding Overseas Exchange Students, Huaqiao University 2021–2022
First-Class Scholarship, Huaqiao University 2022–2023
Outstanding Graduate, Huaqiao University Sep. 2023
WISE Program (TMI) Fellowship, Nagoya University (MEXT-funded) 2025–present
Excellent Presentation Award, DBWS Sep. 11, 2025

Languages: Chinese (native); Japanese (JLPT N2 120/180 N1 109/180); English (TOEFL iBT 103/120, 2022).